AI & THE FUTURE OF EDUCATION CONFERENCE

MAKING SPACE FOR THE HUMAN

Exploring AI’s Role in Easing Educator Workload

GRAB THE
FREE TOOLKIT
Scan any time

PRESENTED BY NICOLE SARGEANT

AI & THE FUTURE OF EDUCATION • BANGKOK 2026 • NIST INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

ABOUT ME

NICOLE SARGEANT

Head of Innovation | Regents International School Pattaya

CLASSROOM + LEADERSHIP

Computer Science educator and whole-school innovation leader. Supporting purposeful AI and technology use across teaching, learning and school systems.

STEAM + COLLABORATION

Former Regional STEAM Lead, Southeast Asia.
Helping educators develop innovative learning through school and MIT collaborations.

RECENTLY COMPLETED NPQSL

National Professional Qualification for Senior Leadership.
My leadership development prompted the staff workload inquiry that informs today's Think Tank.

The question behind this session: how can leadership make more space for the human work of education?

IMAGINE THIS IS TRUE.

AI SAVES A TEACHER

5 HOURS

EVERY WEEK.

What changes?

WHO GETS THOSE FIVE HOURS?

30 SEC • DISCUSS / 30 SEC • SUBMIT

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WE STARTED BY LISTENING

WE DIDN'T START WITH:

~~"How can teachers use AI?"~~

WE STARTED WITH:

"What's consuming people's time?"

41 **staff survey responses**

Regents International School Pattaya • June 2026 • Shared with permission

Diagnose the problem before choosing the intervention.

Inquiry informed by EEF workload research and Department for Education workload and wellbeing guidance.

THE WORKLOAD PICTURE

What we heard at Regents

66% did not agree their workload was acceptable

51% did not agree they had good work-life balance

WHERE STAFF SAID THEY SPENT “TOO MUCH TIME”



Source: RISP Staff Workload Survey, June 2026 | % of respondents, rounded

AI WAS ALREADY PART OF THE PICTURE

93% used AI regularly or occasionally

61% reported saving at least 1 hour per week

MOST COMMON USES

- **76%** Writing reports
- **74%** Creating resources
- **61%** Lesson planning

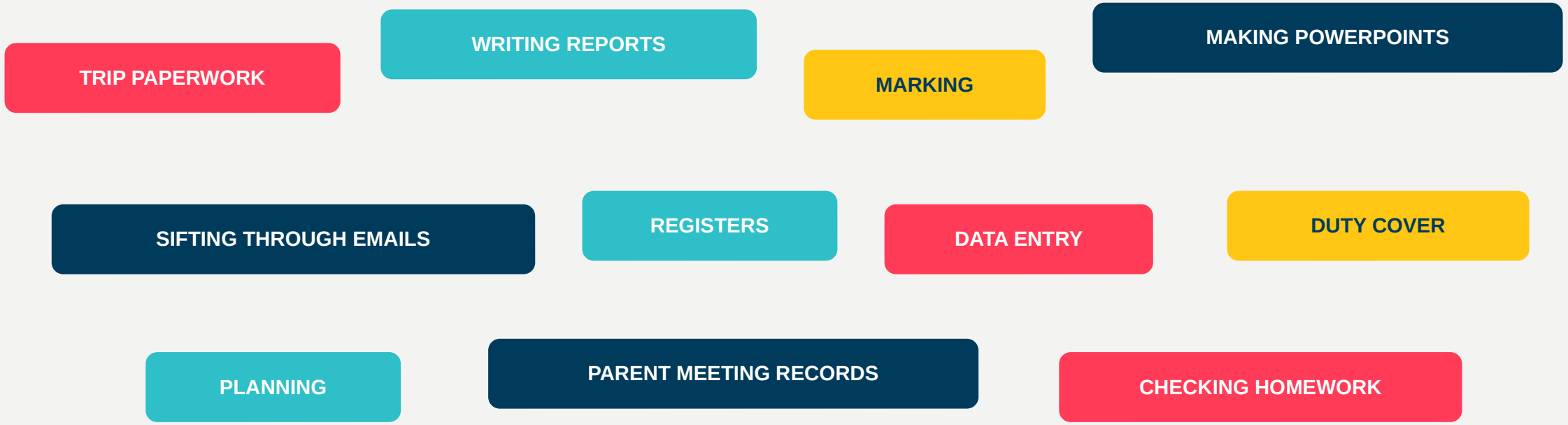
76%

of those answering the quality question said AI improved the quality of their work

Staff were not waiting for AI. They were already experimenting, adapting and saving time.

Source: RISP Staff Workload Survey, June 2026 | Time saved and quality: n=38; AI use cases: n=38

WHAT DID STAFF ACTUALLY WANT HELP WITH?



“It’s 2026 and I am repeating the same data!!!!!”

One colleague described entering the same information into multiple systems.

And one colleague told us they did not want more AI. They wanted more time to do their actual job.

THE ANSWER WASN'T "MORE AI"

Different workload problems need different responses

REMOVE	AI-ASSIST	AUTOMATE / REDESIGN	ORGANISATIONAL	PROTECT
• Duplicated processes	• Planning	• Repeated data entry	• Cover	• Relationships
• Low-value tasks	• Resources	• Routine admin	• Duties	• Professional judgement
• Outdated requirements	• Reports	• Information between systems	• Meetings	• Creativity
	• Communication		• Expectations	• Meaningful feedback
	• Differentiation		• Time	• Thinking

Technology is an option. Not the objective.

MAKING SPACE

A human-centred way to interrogate workload

1

SPOT

Where is time being consumed?

2

QUESTION

Why does this work exist?

3

PROTECT

What must remain meaningfully human?

4

RETHINK

Remove, redesign, automate or AI-assist?

5

RECLAIM

What will we intentionally make space for?

PROTECT comes before RETHINK.

Decide what you do not want technology to take away before deciding what it can do.

MAKING SPACE IN THE CLASSROOM

DEC (Design, Engineer, Construct) Lesson Planner • a custom GPT for a brand-new course

SPOT

A new course with online-only resources. Teachers screenshotted pages into PowerPoint and remade tasks every lesson.

PROTECT

Teacher judgement, our T&L policy and consistencies, and what our learners need.

RETHINK

A custom GPT built on our T&L policy, our T&L consistencies and the full course content.

RECLAIM

Time back for responsive teaching, differentiation and feedback.

ONE PROMPT, UNDER 2 MIN
Objectives + student context in

Teacher PowerPoint | **Student workbook pages** | **Guidance documents** | **Exemplar work** | **EAL key-term grid**

THEN THE TEACHER: **CHALLENGE → ADAPT → ITERATE → TEACH**

PLANNING TIME PER LESSON

Up to 60 min → ~10 min

Teacher estimate from the DEC teaching team, not a timed study.

WORKLOAD REDUCED

No more screenshotting and remaking resources for a course every teacher was new to.

HUMAN CAPACITY

More attention to learners, feedback and creative teaching.

MAKING SPACE IN LEADERSHIP

Teaching & Learning Profile • redesigning the admin around lesson observations

BEFORE 7 steps for every observation, only 2 of them human

1. **Contact teacher to book**
2. **Agree a time slot**
3. **Observe the lesson**
4. **Fill in Word form**
5. **Feedback meeting**
6. **Send, sign and return**
7. **Save to central folder**

AFTER 4 steps for the observer. The system handles the rest.

1 **BOOK** the observation → 2 **OBSERVE** the lesson → 3 **FILL IN** one digital form → 4 **MEET & COACH** face to face

IN THE BACKGROUND FORM → SHAREPOINT → AUTOMATION → ACCESS → COMMUNICATION

No saving or sending back and forth

OBSERVER STEPS

7 → 4

NOW LIVE: WHAT CHANGED

Observations are booked in earlier.
Feedback forms reach the right folder, sooner.

HUMAN CAPACITY

More time and focus for the feedback conversation and follow-up coaching.

“I didn’t ask AI to do the observation. I asked AI to help me redesign everything around it.”

YOUR TURN.

WHAT'S CONSUMING TIME IN YOUR SCHOOL?

1 60 SECONDS ALONE

Write down one recurring workload problem.

2 CHOOSE ONE AT YOUR TABLE

Choose a problem worth interrogating. 1 minute.

3 RUN IT THROUGH MAKING SPACE

6 minutes on your A3 Canvas: SPOT • QUESTION • PROTECT • RETHINK • RECLAIM

You are NOT trying to find a use for AI.

You are trying to design better work.

WHAT ARE YOU MAKING SPACE FOR?

We would use technology to…

We would protect the human role in…

We would use the reclaimed capacity for…

AI SAVES A TEACHER 5 HOURS EVERY WEEK.

WHO SHOULD GET THOSE FIVE HOURS?

DON’T JUST SAVE TIME. DECIDE WHAT YOU’RE MAKING SPACE FOR.

THANK YOU

TAKE THE TOOLKIT HOME

Free, editable resources to run this conversation with your own team.

01 **Meeting-in-a-Box** A 20-minute team conversation plan

02 **A3 Group Canvas** The worksheet from today

03 **AI Thinking Partner** Copy-and-paste redesign prompt

04 **Workload Decision Guide** Remove, redesign, automate or AI-assist?

05 **30-Day Action Plan** Turn one idea into a small pilot

SCAN FOR THE TOOLKIT

PDF and Word downloads

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CONNECT ON LINKEDIN

RESEARCH & RESOURCES

Sources informing the Regents staff workload inquiry

Education Endowment Foundation | Workload Review

Evidence review to inform workload-related thinking.

Department for Education | Conversation Guide for Workload and Wellbeing

Practical prompts for staff and leadership conversations.

Department for Education | Staff Workload Survey

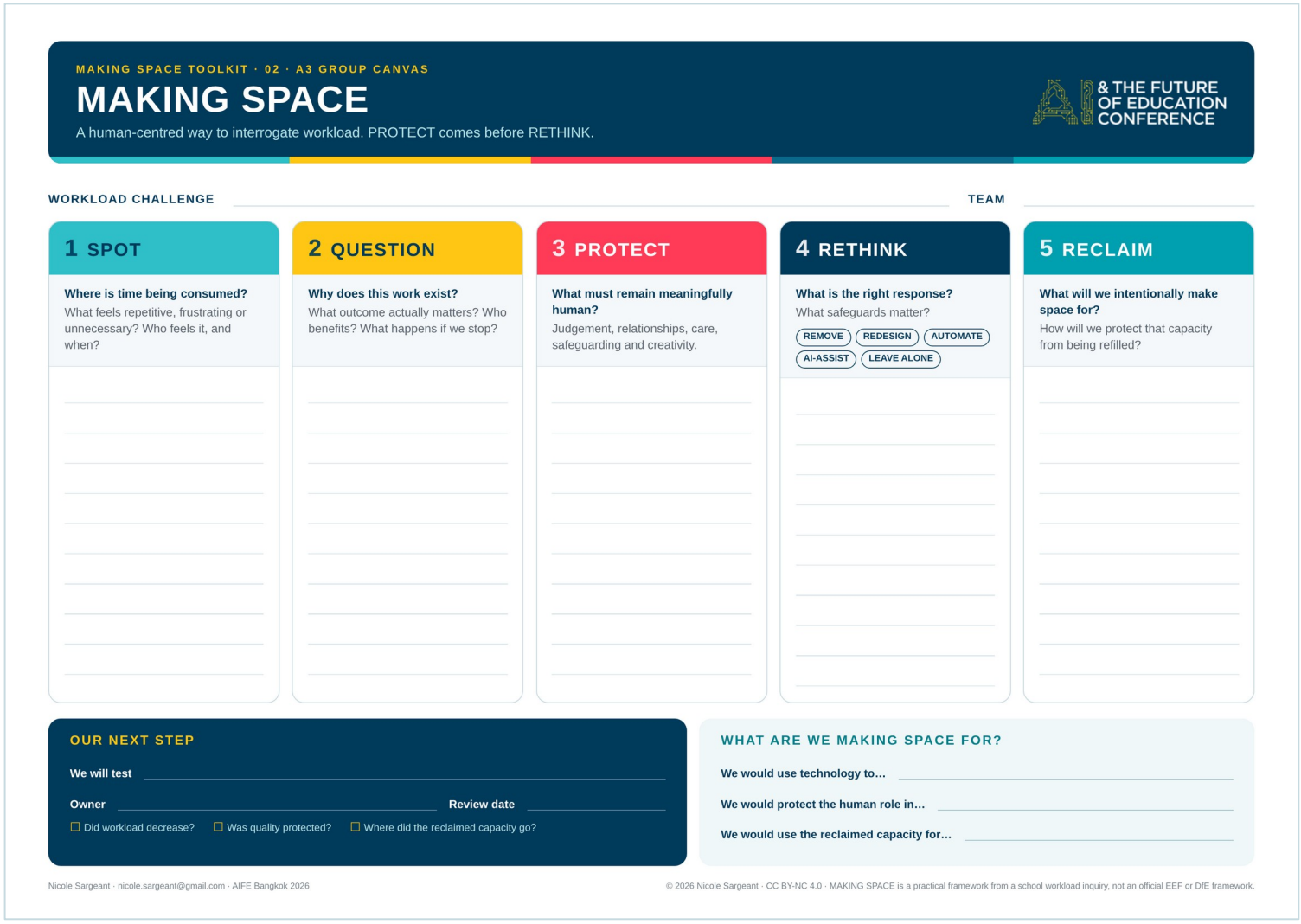
Survey resource to help schools start by listening.

MAKING SPACE is a practical framework developed from this inquiry; it is not an official EEF or DfE framework.

Links are clickable in Slide Show mode.

MAKING SPACE A3 CANVAS

Toolkit 02 • Print at A3 from the toolkit page, one per group



MAKING SPACE TOOLKIT · 02 · A3 GROUP CANVAS

MAKING SPACE

A human-centred way to interrogate workload. PROTECT comes before RETHINK.

& THE FUTURE OF EDUCATION CONFERENCE

WORKLOAD CHALLENGE _____ TEAM _____

1 SPOT

Where is time being consumed?
What feels repetitive, frustrating or unnecessary? Who feels it, and when?

2 QUESTION

Why does this work exist?
What outcome actually matters? Who benefits? What happens if we stop?

3 PROTECT

What must remain meaningfully human?
Judgement, relationships, care, safeguarding and creativity.

4 RETHINK

What is the right response?
What safeguards matter?

REMOVE · REDESIGN · AUTOMATE · AI-ASSIST · LEAVE ALONE

5 RECLAIM

What will we intentionally make space for?
How will we protect that capacity from being refilled?

OUR NEXT STEP

We will test _____

Owner _____ **Review date** _____

☐ Did workload decrease? ☐ Was quality protected? ☐ Where did the reclaimed capacity go?

WHAT ARE WE MAKING SPACE FOR?

We would use technology to… _____

We would protect the human role in… _____

We would use the reclaimed capacity for… _____

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